Remote Work and Information Security Policy

Internal draft - approval required before employee use

Effective date: Pending approval

Policy owners: People Operations and Information Security

1. Purpose

This policy defines remote-work eligibility, approved locations, availability, equipment, acceptable use, data protection, and incident reporting. It applies whenever an employee performs Northstar Labs work outside a company-controlled location, including during business travel.

2. Remote-Work Eligibility

Remote work is the normal arrangement for roles Northstar Labs designates as remote-eligible. Eligibility depends on job duties, performance, team coverage, data restrictions, and the employee's ability to maintain a safe and secure workspace. A remote arrangement may be reviewed when business or compliance needs change.

Employees must provide an accurate primary work address to People Operations. The approved address is used for payroll, tax, insurance, equipment, and employment-law administration.

3. Working From Another Location

Short-term work from another location within the employee's approved state requires manager awareness and continued compliance with security and availability requirements. Working from a different state for more than 30 calendar days requires advance written approval from People Operations and the employee's manager.

Employees must request review before beginning work from another country, regardless of duration. Approval is not guaranteed and may be limited by immigration, tax, customer, insurance, export-control, or information-security requirements.

Personal travel does not make lodging, meals, transportation, or connectivity reimbursable. Business travel reimbursement is governed by the Travel and Expense Policy.

4. Availability and Workspace

Employees must be reachable during normal collaboration hours of 10:00 a.m. through 3:00 p.m. Eastern Time unless they have approved leave, an agreed schedule, or an emergency. Role-specific coverage may extend beyond these hours.

The remote workspace must support confidential conversations, safe equipment use, reliable connectivity, and professional participation in meetings. Employees should prevent household members and visitors from viewing confidential information or using company devices.

5. Company Equipment

Northstar Labs provides equipment appropriate to the role. Company equipment remains company property, must be used primarily for authorized business, and must be returned when requested or when employment ends.

Employees must not disable security controls, install unapproved software, share devices with another person, or connect company equipment to an untrusted device. Loss, theft, or damage must be reported promptly.

6. Identity and Access

Employees must use unique credentials, approved password management, and multi-factor authentication where provided. Credentials and authentication approvals may never be shared. Employees must lock the screen when leaving a device unattended and must report unexpected authentication prompts.

Access is limited to information needed for assigned work. Downloading confidential data to a personal device, personal email account, consumer storage service, or removable media is prohibited unless Information Security gives written approval.

7. Network and Data Protection

Employees should use a trusted private network. Public Wi-Fi may be used only with the approved secure connection and when confidential conversations and screens cannot be observed. Sensitive documents must be stored in approved company systems and securely destroyed when retention is no longer required.

When traveling for business, employees must keep devices under their control, avoid leaving equipment in vehicles, and follow the Travel and Expense Policy for approved connectivity or equipment costs.

8. Security Incidents

A suspected or confirmed security incident must be reported to Information Security within one hour of discovery. This includes lost or stolen equipment, suspicious messages, malware warnings, unexpected multi-factor prompts, accidental disclosure, misdirected email containing confidential data, or unauthorized system access.

Employees should report quickly even when all facts are not known. Do not delay notification to investigate independently, erase evidence, negotiate with an attacker, or decide whether the event is serious. Information Security will provide containment instructions.

9. Acceptable Use and Monitoring

Company systems are provided for legitimate business use. Limited personal use is permitted when it is lawful, does not interfere with work, does not create material cost, and does not violate another policy. Prohibited uses include harassment, unlawful activity, unauthorized commercial activity, circumvention of security controls, and storing offensive or pirated content.

Northstar Labs may monitor, access, preserve, or disclose company systems and information for security, operations, legal, or compliance purposes, subject to applicable law. Employees should not expect personal privacy in company accounts or devices beyond legal requirements.

10. Questions and Exceptions

People Operations reviews location and workplace questions. Information Security reviews technical controls and data-handling exceptions. Managers may not approve an exception that belongs to either function. Any exception must be written, time-limited, and include compensating controls when appropriate.